



AMETHYST ACADEMY EXPANDED

STATBLOCKS, TACTICS, SAYINGS, & ENCOUNTERS

HOME BREW

Expanding the Amethyst Academy faction from
Dungeons of Drakkenheim for 5e

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THE AMETHYST ACADEMY, EXPANDED



THE MAGES OF THE AMETHYST ACADEMY ARE CUNNING, SLIPPERY, AND WELL-PREPARED. THE ACADEMY IS A FORMIDABLE opponent to any who would dare stand in their way. In their enigmatic hideouts scattered across the Continent, the Academy hoards Delerium and enacts their secretive plans. Delerium offers the promise of powerful magics, wondrous items, and pushing the frontier of what is possible. Will the Academy achieve its lofty goals, or will their hubris bring about their downfall?

DESIGN GOALS

- Expanded content for a *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* campaign, but the statblocks are reusable anywhere!
- Create a unifying trait that represents the Amethyst Academy that highlights their preparation, cunning, and resourcefulness
- Create more flavorful and powerful caster statblocks than the **Mage** from the SRD
- Create spellcaster statblocks with the good parts of design from *Monsters of the Multiverse* (simplified spell lists, no spell slots, powerful attacks and multiattacks, spellcasting mixed in with multiattack) but that still have interesting signature spells to cast

RANKS WITHING THE ACADEMY

This information is summarized from a [Discord Post](#) by Monty Martin, co-author of *Dungeons of Drakkenheim*

The academy has a tiered ranking system based on experience and highest level spell known:

Spell Levels	Title	Description
	Wards	Children age 6 to 12 who have been taken in by the academy. Wards learn to control their magic and receive a high-quality education while living in a “boarding school”
0-1	Apprentices*	Teenagers age 13+ instructed by a Master Mage professor. Taught cantrips and 1st level spells. Carry out many housekeeping duties and act as assistants / test subjects
2	Journeyman*	Once they learn 2nd-level spells they receive an “internship” assignment in the wider world.
3-4	Guild Mages*	Completed their training and are full members of the Academy. They are often given specific missions and assignments in the world (such as crafting magic items, working under senior mages, or even missions out in the world, occasionally they are posted to a prominent Count or Baron as court mage)
5-7	Master Mage*	A Guild Mage who gains their 5th Ring is a Master Wizard. Master Wizards are invited to the College, an inner circle which may petition and nominate the Archmages. Under the Edicts of Lumen, the Academy is required to offer the council and service of a Master Wizard to any noble holding the rank of Duke or higher.
8	Grandmaster Mage*	A Grandmaster Wizard wears at least 8 rings, but often the title is withheld until the mage attains a 9th ring. Grandmaster Wizards are eligible to be nominated to the position on the Archmage Council
9	Archmage	There are only 8 (sometimes 9) individuals with this rank. All are able to cast 9th level spells. These are the leaders of the Academy. They hold the position for life (or unlfe) or voluntary retirement.

This supplement has statblocks for the **Academy Apprentice**, **Journeyman Mage**, **Guild Mage**, **Master Mage**, and **Grandmaster Mage**.

UTILITY SPELLS

The statblocks presented in this supplement utilize the style from *Monsters of the Multiverse* where a simplified spell list is provided and no spell slots are tracked. This is to make it easier to run the spellcaster. Academy mages know many other spells in addition to the ones listed in their statblock. If you wish, you may give any academy member any of the following utility spells. These spells can be cast once per day and are generally not intended to be cast in combat. These spells are intended to be cast “offscreen” or to help the PCs if they are working with the Academy.

UTILITY SPELLS

Rank	Utility Spells
Journeyman	<i>Alarm</i> , <i>Comprehend Language</i> , <i>Detect Magic</i> ^c , <i>Find Familiar</i> , <i>Identify</i>
Guild Mage	<i>Magic Mouth</i> , <i>See Invisibility</i> , <i>Skywrite</i> , <i>Unseen Servant</i> , <i>Sending</i> , <i>Remove Curse</i> , <i>Water Breathing</i>
Master Mage	<i>Fly</i> ^c , <i>Gaseous Form</i> ^c , <i>Glyph of Warding</i> , <i>Nondetection</i> , <i>Private Sanctum</i> , <i>Scrying</i> ^c , <i>Teleportation Circle</i>
Grandmaster Mage	<i>Contact Other Plane</i> , <i>Telepathic Bond</i> , <i>True Seeing</i> , <i>Teleport</i>

ONE STEP AHEAD

The foresight and preparation of Academy members is represented by the defensive *One Step Ahead* reaction. You can rollplay this reaction as the result of a *Contingency*, *Divination*, *Augery*, or *Scrying*, or just general intelligence and preparation that allowed the mage to gather the necessary information to be prepared to face the PCs.

One Step Ahead (1/day). If the academy member is the target of an attack or hostile spell that they can see and is missing at least one hitpoint, then the mage may use their reaction to cast *Misty Step*, *Greater Invisibility* (requires Guild Mage rank), or *Wall of Force* (requires Master Mage rank) from their Academy Ring without requiring any verbal, somatic, or material components. If the original attack or spell targeted the mage and it can no longer target the mage it fails.

DESIGN NOTE - WHY NO COUNTERSPELL OR SHIELD?
The spellcaster statblocks listed below do not have *Counterspell* or *Shield* (with the exception of the apprentice) because the *One Step Ahead* reaction essentially acts as a more powerful counterspell or shield. The mage can teleport out of harm's way, or become invisible to avoid being targeted by a spell, or even create a *Wall of Force* to block spells or attacks. It would be frustrating to PCs for Amethyst Academy mages to also have *Counterspell* and/or *Shield* on top of this already powerful defensive ability.

ACADEMY APPRENTICE

The Amethyst Academy has many young **Academy Apprentices** being trained. Some of these apprentices accompany their teachers on field expeditions to Drakkenheim. Apprentices are not combat trained and retreat when outmatched.

ACADEMY APPRENTICE

Medium Humanoid, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 13 (mage armor)
Hit Points 18 (4d6 + 4)
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	11 (+0)	11 (+0)

Skills Arcana+4, History+4
Senses passive Perception 10

Languages Common, Elvish
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Innate Spellcasting The apprentice's innate spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 12, +4 to hit with spell attacks). The apprentice can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

1/day each: *Burning Hands*, *Magic Missile*, *Shield*

ACTIONS

Arcane Bolt. Ranged Spell Attack: +4 to hit, range 120 ft, one target. Hit 10 (3d6) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage.

JOURNEYMAN MAGE

When the apprentice masters 2nd-level spells, they become a **Journeyman Mage** and are sent out into the wider world and receive their Academy Ring. Mechanically, this is represented by the *One Step Ahead* reaction. In combat, the Journeyman starts with *Web* and uses *Invisibility* or *One Step Ahead* to flee if it is at 26 health or lower.

JOURNEYMAN MAGE

Medium Humanoid, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 14 (mage armor)
Hit Points 36 (8d6 + 8)
Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	16 (+2)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills Arcana+5, History+5
Senses passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Draconic, Elvish
Challenge 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Innate Spellcasting The mage's innate spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). The

apprentice can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

1/day each: *Burning Hands*, *Invisibility* ^c, *Web* ^c

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The mage makes two Arcane Bolt attacks.

Arcane Bolt. Ranged Spell Attack: +5 to hit, range 120 ft, one target. Hit 10 (3d6) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage.

REACTIONS

One Step Ahead (1/day). If the mage is the target of an attack or hostile spell that they can see and is missing at least one hitpoint, then the mage may use their reaction to cast *Misty Step* from their Academy Ring without requiring any verbal, somatic, or material components. If the original attack or spell targeted the mage and it can no longer target the mage it fails.

GUILD MAGE

The **Guild Mage** is of the 3rd or 4th circle. Academy members do not often enter the ruins or engage in combat directly, but they occasionally lead survey teams into the ruins to carry out research. Mages are always prepared for trouble and are often escorted by an **Academy Guardian** and other elemental summons (see *Encounters*). If combat does break out, the mage focuses on accomplishing their objective. In many cases, this means the mage focuses on escaping, but if the objective requires direct confrontation then the mage will be efficient and ruthless.

In combat, mages prioritize staying near their guardian while also maintaining a healthy distance from threats. Mages will typically start combat by using an *Arcane Spear* attack and casting one of its concentration spells. *Haste* or *Fly* is excellent for escape. *Slow* is a powerful debuff to start combat with. Or, if there is an opportunity for an ambush, the mage can utilize *Major Image*. The mage uses *One Step Ahead* to protect itself, either by teleporting to safety or by simply applying *Greater Invisibility* to make a safe escape.

GUILD MAGE

Medium Humanoid, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 15 (mage armor)

Hit Points 77 (14d6 + 28)

Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	12 (+2)

Saving Throws INT+7, WIS+5

Skills Arcana+7, History+7

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Draconic, Elvish, Infernal

Challenge 6 (2,300 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Innate Spellcasting. The mage's innate spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). The mage can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

1/day each: *Fly* ^c, *Invisibility* ^c, *Major Image* ^c, *Haste* ^c, *Slow* ^c, *Dispel Magic*

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The mage makes two *Arcane Spear* attacks, or one *Arcane Spear* attack and uses its Spellcasting.

Arcane Spear. Ranged Spell Attack: +7 to hit, range 120 ft, one target. Hit 22 (4d8 + 4) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage.

Arcane Blast. The mage magically creates a burst of arcane energy in a 15 ft radius sphere centered on a point within 120 feet. Each creature in that area must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 28 (8d6) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage. On a success, the creature takes half damage. This action counts as a 3rd-level spell.

BONUS ACTIONS

Step Between Worlds (2/day). The mage teleports, along with any equipment it is wearing or carrying, up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space that it can see.

REACTIONS

One Step Ahead (1/day). If the mage is the target of an attack or hostile spell that they can see and is missing at least one hitpoint, then the mage may use their reaction to cast *Misty Step* or *Greater Invisibility* ^c from their Academy Ring without requiring any verbal, somatic, or material components. If the original attack or spell targeted the mage and it can no longer target the mage it fails.

MASTER MAGE

The **Master Mage** represents a mage of the 5th-7th circle. It has similar combat tactics to the **Guild Mage**, except that it has some notably improved powers. With a 15 ft hover, it will prefer to hover off the ground to avoid attacks from pesky melee fighters. When starting combat, it usually prefers to open with one of its powerful concentration spells, depending on the situation. *Dominate Person* is an excellent choice against simple-minded opponents, *Arcane Hand* is an excellent all-around offensive or defensive tool, and *Wall of Ice* can be a great damaging or battlefield control spell. The mage reserves *Power Word Pain* for what it appears to be the biggest threat to it. Often this is range attackers or other spellcasters.

If the mage believes itself to be outmatched, it can use *Greater Invisibility* or *Mislead* to escape. Or, these spells can be used to set up an effective ambush. The Master Mage also has access to a reactionary *Wall of Force*. This is an extremely powerful ability as it can be used both offensively and defensively. For example, in response to being attacked by a melee attacker, the mage can cast a *Wall of Force* which not only prevents the attack, but blocks future attacks and spells. This is perhaps the most potent ability of the Master Mage.

MASTER MAGE

Medium Humanoid, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 16 (masterwork mage armor)

Hit Points 99 (18d6 + 36)

Speed 30ft, fly 15ft (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws INT+9, WIS+6

Skills Arcana+13, History+13

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Draconic, Elvish, Infernal, Primordial

Challenge 8 (5,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Innate Spellcasting. The mage's innate spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 16, +8 to hit with spell attacks). The mage can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

1/day each: *Greater Invisibility* ^c, *Dispel Magic* (4th), *Mislead* ^c, *Dominate Person* ^c, *Arcane Hand* ^c, *Wall of Ice* ^c, *Power Word Pain*

Masterwork Spellcraft. The mage has advantage on concentration checks and on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The mage makes two Arcane Spear attacks, or uses Arcane Spear and its Spellcasting.

Arcane Spear. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +9 to hit, range 120 ft, one target. *Hit* 27 (5d8 + 5) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage.

Arcane Blast. The mage magically creates a burst of arcane energy in a 15 ft radius sphere centered on a point within 120 feet. Each creature in that area must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 31 (9d6) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage and is pushed 10 feet away from the mage. On a success, the creature takes half damage. This action counts as a 4th-level spell.

BONUS ACTIONS

Step Between Worlds (2/day). The mage teleports, along with any equipment it is wearing or carrying, up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space that it can see.

REACTIONS

One Step Ahead (1/day). If the mage is the target of an attack or hostile spell that they can see and is missing at least one hitpoint, then the mage may use their reaction to cast *Misty Step*, *Greater Invisibility* ^c, or *Wall of Force* ^c from their Academy Ring without requiring any verbal, somatic, or material components. If the original attack or spell targeted the mage and it can no longer target the mage it fails.

ACADEMY GUARDIAN

The **Academy Guardian** is a magically animated protective construct. The Academy keeps a handful of these constructs available for use by apprentices and journeymen going on field expeditions. As part of receiving their 5th ring and being granted the title of **Master Mage**, many mages will craft their own guardian as a rite of passage and a practical defensive measure. The guardian prioritizes staying near its charge to ensure its *Protector* feature is active and attacks melee attackers that are approaching its charge to grapple them. As soon as its charge is reduced to half HP, it uses the *Guardian Shield* to protect its charge. If one of its charges is affected by a debilitating spell or effect, it uses *Nullify* to end that effect.

ACADEMY GUARDIAN

Large Construct, Unaligned

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 114(12d10 + 48)

Speed 30ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	8 (-1)	18 (+4)	7 (-2)	10 (+0)	3 (-4)

Damage Immunities poison

Condition Immunities charmed, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned, exhaustion

Senses blindsight 10 ft, darkvision 60 ft, passive Perception 10

Languages Understands its creators but can't speak

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Protector. If the guardian is within 60 feet of an Academy Member, half of any damage the Academy Member takes (rounded up) is transferred to the guardian.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The guardian makes two fist attacks. If both attacks hit, the target is **Grappled** (escape DC 15).

Fist. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 10 ft, one target. *Hit* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Nullify. The guardian chooses a friendly academy mage within 60 feet. For each spell of level X or below affecting the mage, the guardian may choose to end that spell, where X is the mage's Intelligence modifier. The guardian then takes 1d6 force damage for each level of spell nullified.

REACTIONS

Guardian Shield (1/day). In reaction to an academy member within 30 ft going below half its HP, the Guardian casts *Resilient Sphere* ^c on that academy member.

GRANDMASTER MAGE

The **Grandmaster Mage** represents a mage of the 8th circle and is a formidable foe. It uses all the same tactics as a **Master Mage**, but has several additional tricks. Its *Arcane Lance* can be used to push targets away, and it has the ability to use an *Arcane Blast* in addition to using its Spellcasting. Its signature spells include *Globe of Invulnerability* which can be highly effective at neutralizing enemy spellcasters and *Power Word Stun* which can also be used to control a pesky threat.

GRANDMASTER MAGE

Medium Humanoid, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 16 (masterwork mage armor)

Hit Points 104(16d8 + 32)

Speed 30ft, fly 30ft (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Saving Throws INT+9, WIS+6

Skills Arcana+13, History+13

Senses passive Perception 12

Languages Common, Draconic, Elvish, Infernal, Primordial

Challenge 10 (5,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Innate Spellcasting. The mage's innate spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 17, +9 to hit with spell attacks). The mage can innately cast the following spells, requiring no material components:

1/day each: *Greater Invisibility* ^c, *Dispel Magic* (4th), *Mislead* ^c, *Dominare Person* ^c, *Arcane Hand* ^c, *Globe of Invulnerability* ^c, *Power Word Pain*, *Power Word Stun*

Masterwork Spellcraft. The mage has advantage on concentration checks and on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The mage makes three Arcane Lance attacks, or uses Arcane Blast and its Spellcasting.

Arcane Lance. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +9 to hit, range 120 ft, one target. *Hit* 23 (4d8 + 5) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage, and the target is pushed back 10 ft. if it is Large or smaller.

Arcane Blast. The mage magically creates a burst of arcane energy in a 15 ft radius sphere centered on a point within 120 feet. Each creature in that area must make a DC 17 Dexterity saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 35 (10d6) fire, lightning, cold, or acid damage and is pushed 10 feet away from the mage. On a success, the creature takes half damage. This action counts as a 5th-level spell.

BONUS ACTIONS

Step Between Worlds (3/day). The mage teleports, along with any equipment it is wearing or carrying, up to 60 feet to an unoccupied space that it can see.

REACTIONS

One Step Ahead (1/day). If the mage is the target of an attack or hostile spell that they can see and is missing at least one hitpoint, then the mage may use their reaction to cast *Misty Step*, *Greater Invisibility* ^c, or *Wall of Force* ^c from their Academy Ring without requiring any verbal, somatic, or material components. If the original attack or spell targeted the mage and it can no longer target the mage it fails.

CREATING YOUR OWN

There are many statblocks for spellcasters. *Monsters of the Multiverse* in particular has some reasonable statblocks for various wizards, such as the **Diviner Wizard** or **Evoker Wizard**. If you want to "transform" one of these statblocks into an Amethyst Academy statblock, simply add the *One Step Ahead* reaction, and optionally add the *Utility Spells* listed above.

ENCOUNTERS

The Amethyst Academy are primarily scholars, researchers, and behind-the-scenes movers. They rarely engage in direct confrontation by choice and instead prefer to have others do their fighting for them. If PCs are moving against the Amethyst Academy members in combat, then they should have already dealt with many Elementals and hired Mercenaries. These encounters are intended to be Hard to Deadly at the indicated level.

HIRED HELP

See my [Dogs of War](#) supplement for the **Merc Captain**, **Bounty Hunter**, **Spellsworn**, and **Merc Medic** statblocks

Hired Muscle (lv4) - the Academy has hired a **Bugbear** leader, **Orc** muscle, **Spy** scout, **Acolyte**, and pet **Dire Wolf** to deal with the situation.

Rival Mercenaries (lv8) - the Academy has hired a **Merc Captain**, **Ogre** muscle, **Bounty Hunter**, **Priest**, and pet **Dire Wolf** to deal with the situation. The captain has been given a *Bead of Force* with 4 charges

Well-Prepared Rivals (lv11) - the Academy has hired a **Merc Captain**, **Hill Giant** muscle, **Bounty Hunter**, **Merc Medic**, and a pet **Owlbear** to deal with the situation. The captain has been given a *Bead of Force* with 4 charges and all 5 members have been given a *Potion of Invisibility*. If outside the haze, the Academy will confirm the PCs are in a vulnerable position with *Scrying* and *Teleport* their forces into the fray.

Any of the above encounters can be enhanced by adding summoned **Mephits** at low levels or an additional summoned **Air Elemental**, **Earth Elemental**, **Water Elemental**, or **Fire Elemental**.

ASSASSINATION SQUADS

CAUTION

These encounters are at least Deadly. The Amethyst Academy is not a foe to be trifled with and will act ruthlessly if pressed.

The academy always waits for an opportune moment to send its assassins. They confirm the targets are no longer in the Haze via spies (such as mephits or imps) and then use *Scrying* to confirm the exact location. Agents are sent in via *Teleport* and have been buffed with an *Invisibility* or *Greater Invisibility* spell cast on them. If the player characters are hiding inside magical protection, then a **Guild Mage** with *Greater Invisibility* accompanies the hit squad and uses *Dispel Magic* before disappearing with *Dimension Door*.

Shadowy Assassins (Tier 2). The PCs pose a serious danger to the Academy's mission and the Academy wishes for them to be dealt with. The Academy is willing to spend ~5k gold on the assassination of the PCs. 1 **Bounty Hunter** and 2 **Invisible Stalker** silently and invisibly drop in to kill the PCs using the tactics described above.

Existential Threat (Tier 3). The PCs pose a grave danger to the Academy and must be dealt with. The Academy is willing to spend ~15k gold on the assassination of the PCs. 4 **Fire Elemental** are teleported in (not invisible) to cause a commotion and distract the PCs. Shortly thereafter, 1 **Bounty Hunter**, 1 **Spellsworn** and 2 **Invisible Stalker** teleport in silently and invisibly using the tactics described above.

ACADEMY MAGES

Academy members do not seek out direct conflict themselves unless as a last resort. This implies PCs should only be fighting mages directly if they are in an advantageous position. These combats are all intended to be Deadly for the listed level.

- lv2, CR2: 2 **Academy Apprentice** and 2 **Ice/Dust/Magma Mephit**
- lv4, CR4: 1 **Journeyman Mage**, 2 **Academy Apprentice**, and 2 **Ice/Dust/Magma Mephit**
- lv6, CR12: 1 **Guild Mage**, 1 **Academy Guardian**, and 2 **Academy Apprentice**
- lv8, CR16: 1 **Guild Mage**, 1 **Academy Guardian**, and 1 **Earth/Air/Fire/Water Elemental**
- lv10, CR23: 1 **Master Mage**, 1 **Academy Guardian**, and 2 **Earth/Air/Fire/Water Elemental**
- lv12, CR28: 1 **Grandmaster Mage**, 1 **Guild Mage**, 2 **Academy Guardian**, and 4 **Academy Apprentice**

Any of the above encounters can be enhanced by first adding an encounter from the **Hired Help** section, or by adding additional "understudy" mages of a lower rank to the combat, such as adding a **Journeyman Mage** to a fight featuring a **Guild Mage**, or a **Guild Mage** to a fight featuring a **Grandmaster Mage**. These understudies would focus on buffing and supporting the higher-ranking mage and controlling enemy combatants.

SAYINGS

One of the most challenging parts of running a faction is creating appropriate sayings for the faction members. These can be difficult to improvise on the spot. This table provides some quotations that can be used to help you run Amethyst Academy social encounters.

SAYINGS OF THE AMETHYST ACADEMY

D20 Quote

- 1 "The Academy seeks to understand the potential of Delerium and harness it for the benefit of all."
- 2 "Our mission is to uncover the secrets of the multiverse and unlock the true power of the arcane."
- 3 "Our research is driven by a desire to bring new discoveries to the world and advance the field of magic."
- 4 "The Academy seeks to advance the knowledge and understanding of magic to benefit all who practice it."
- 5 "We believe that knowledge and strategy are the keys to overcoming any obstacle."
- 6 "The Academy approaches challenges with careful planning and calculated risk-taking."
- 7 "Our mages are trained to analyze the situation and respond with precision and skill."
- 8 "We seek to be one step ahead of our enemies, anticipating their every move and countering it with swift action."
- 9 "In the face of adversity, the Academy stands steadfast and resolute, confident in our knowledge and skill."
- 10 "We believe that Delerium holds the key to unlocking new frontiers of knowledge and power."
- 11 "The Academy values discretion and will not be held responsible for any unorthodox methods employed during the mission."
- 12 "We need results, and we are willing to offer significant resources to those who can help us achieve them."
- 13 "The Silver Order is blinded by their own dogma and prejudice. They fear what they do not understand."
- 14 "The Academy's research is conducted with the utmost care and precision, and we take every precaution to ensure the safety of our mages and the surrounding environment."
- 15 "Our research is vital to unlocking the full potential of magic and bringing new discoveries to the world."
- 16 "Critics of the Academy fail to see the long-term benefits of our research, and are blinded by their own ignorance and fear."
- 17 "The Academy operates in accordance with the Edicts of Lumen. We welcome constructive criticism from those who seek to understand our work rather than naively fear what they do not comprehend."
- 18 "The potential of Delerium is limitless - with its unique properties, we can create magic that is more powerful, more precise, and more efficient than ever before."
- 19 "With Delerium, we have the power to reshape the world in ways that were once unimaginable."
- 20 "Delerium is a rare, precious, and dangerous substance. We must use it wisely. But not to use this resource would be utter foolishness. With proper research and application, we can unlock incredible advancements in the field of magic."

FACTION ALLIANCES

This material is a summary of the [Drakkenheim Faction Alliance](#) cheat sheet, focusing on just the Academy.

AMETHYST ACADEMY ALLIANCE PARTNERS

Alliance Partner	Difficulty to Establish	Difficulty to Maintain
Hooded Lanterns	Easy	Hard
Queen's Men	Easy	Hard
Falling Fire	Hard	Moderate
Silver Order	Temporary Only	Very Hard

ACADEMY + HOODED LANTERNS

Difficulty: *Easy* to establish in the short term but *Hard* to maintain in the long term because the Academy doesn't have a long-term interest in restoring Drakkenheim.

SHARED IDEALS

Delerium is a Resource - The Hooded Lanterns need funding, and the Academy has resources. Together, we can make things happen.

HOODED LANTERN DEMANDS

Financial Support - the Lanterns demand material support for their hefty expenses **Potions** - the Lanterns require healing potions, and especially aqua expurgo once available

AMETHYST ACADEMY DEMANDS

Retake the Tower - the Academy demands assistance from elite lantern scouts to secure staging grounds within the city and assist them in retaking the tower

POTENTIAL CONFLICTS

Future of the City (Long) - the Amethyst Academy doesn't have a long-term stake in restoring Drakkenheim as they essentially view it as a Delerium mine that they should have exclusive rights to. The PCs would need to work to change the Academy's goals, which should be difficult. This tension has been playing out quite a bit in the Fate of Drakkenheim livestream.

FACTION RESPONSES

The Silver Order would push for the Hooded Lanterns to drop the Amethyst Academy and work with them to cleanse the city so that it can be remade. If that fails, the Silver Order would threaten to blockade the Lantern's supply routes and cut them off. The Queen of Thieves would attempt to infiltrate the alliance and utilize it to gather the seals for her, so she just needs to steal them. The Falling Fire would try to convert the Hooded Lanterns to their cause.

ACADEMY + QUEEN'S MEN

Difficulty: *Easy* to establish in the short term, *Hard* to maintain long term due to the backstabbing nature of both factions

SHARED IDEALS

- **Delerium is a Resource** - Delerium is extremely valuable. The Queen's Men can find it, and the Academy will buy it. It's a win-win!
- **Drakkenheim Doesn't Need Rulers** - other factions will just get in the way of business

QUEEN'S MEN DEMANDS

- **Exclusive Supplier** - the Queen's Men want negotiated contracts with the Academy and guarantees that no other Delerium suppliers may sell to the Academy
- **Let Chaos Reign** - the Queen's Men ask the Academy to stymie any efforts by the Hooded Lanterns or Silver Order to gain further footholds in the city

ACADEMY DEMANDS

- **Let the Delerium Flow** - the Academy requires a constant flow of Delerium and does not tolerate any deviation from committed quotas
- **Unmask the Queen** - the Academy needs to know who they are dealing with

POTENTIAL CONFLICTS

The Edicts of Lumen - if the Queen of Thieves' true goals are discovered, then there will debate within the Academy on whether the Edicts of Lumen should be honored, or whether they should be cast aside and the Academy should support crowning Katarina von Kessel

FACTION RESPONSES

The Silver Order seeks to ally with the Hooded Lanterns to counterbalance the growing power of their rivals. The Falling Fire tries to encourage hostilities between the two blocs to further its own aims.

AMETHYST ACADEMY + FALLING FIRE

Difficulty: *Hard* to establish in the short term because it requires both factions to compromise on the use of Delerium. *Moderate* to maintain long-term if PCs can enforce compromise.

SHARED IDEALS

Delerium is Key - Delerium is the most important substance on this planet. We can't allow others to foolishly destroy this divine gift.

Expel the Silver Order - we must send the Silver Order back to Elyria. Their dangerous ideas have no business in Westemar

FALLING FIRE DEMANDS

Expel the Silver Order - the Amethyst Academy must use its influence to sabotage the Silver Order's attempts at gaining a foothold in Temple Gate.

Conversion - the sincere sanctification of a couple of high-profile Academy members would demonstrate that it's never too late to find the path of righteousness.

AMETHYST ACADEMY DEMANDS

Retake the Tower - the Academy demands assistance from elite sanctified Falling Fire members in scouting out and retaking the tower

POTENTIAL CONFLICTS

Sharing Delerium - both factions need to be convinced by the PCs to allow the other to utilize Delerium and to not walk away from the table unless they get 100% of the Delerium they want. This should be difficult to overcome, but once overcome, could set up a fruitful collaboration.

Prejudice - there is a history of conflict between the faith and the arcane to overcome.

FACTION RESPONSES

The Silver Order would push for an alliance with the Hooded Lanterns to accomplish their joint goals of getting Delerium out of the city. The Queen's Men would attempt to weaken the alliance from within through subterfuge.

ACADEMY + SILVER ORDER

At the start of the campaign, these two factions have deep-seated animosity against each other. The most likely reason for these two to ally would be in response to the Falling Fire gaining a major presence in the city. Even then, the alliance would be a temporary one of convenience and would break apart shortly. It's also possible that the Amethyst Academy could realize that Delerium poses an existential threat and be willing to enact the Silver Order's plans, but that would require major work to change the Academy's goals.

IMPROBABLE ALLIANCES

Some alliances seem almost impossible to establish at the start of the campaign due to fundamental incompatibilities in beliefs. It would be very difficult for these factions to proactively work together.

There are some situations where an alliance of these factions could occur:

- As a temporary response against a powerful PC-led alliance
- PCs take over the faction and replace its leadership structure
- PCs re-engineer the core beliefs or goals of the factions somehow
- PCs infiltrate the faction as "puppet-masters"
- PCs dismantle the faction and absorb the pieces into their own

In most of these cases, the alliance wouldn't really be about negotiating and compromise, but instead would focus on taking down a shared threat. It would break down shortly afterwards.

CREDITS

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The wonderful *Dungeons of Drakkenheim* sourcebook by The Dungeon Dudes from Ghostfire Games is the source of the Amethyst Academy faction that this supplement expands upon. Additional information about the Amethyst Academy is also summarized from a post by Monty Martin in the DungeonDudes discord.

Thanks to Mike Shea and his *City of Arches* for the **Exiled Mage** statblock which served as inspiration.

The monster building guidelines from *Level Up Advanced 5e Monstrous Menagerie* by Paul Hughes were used as a starting point for these statblocks

OTHER DRAKKENHEIM HOMEBREW FROM CORDIALGERM

- [Falling Fire Expanded](#)
- [Hooded Lanterns Expanded](#)
- [Silver Order Expanded](#)

OTHER HOMEBREW FROM CORDIALGERM

- [Dogs of War - Mercs Expanded](#)